“Satan has power over me, and I am helpless.”

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Where it often comes from

Frightening stories or movies about demonic power. Teaching that focused more on the devil’s strength than on Christ’s victory. Long struggles with temptation, fear, or dark thoughts that seem impossible to escape. Past involvement in the occult. Trauma that left you feeling powerless in general.

What Scripture teaches

Satan is real, but he is a defeated enemy. At the cross, Christ disarmed the powers and authorities and triumphed over them. The One who lives in you is greater than the one who is in the world. You are not helpless: you can submit to God, resist the devil, and he will flee. The Lord is faithful to strengthen you and guard you from the evil one.

> *“You, little children, are from God and have overcome them, because greater is He who is in you than he who is in the world”* **(1 John 4:4)**.

Also see

> “And having disarmed the powers and authorities, He made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross” **(Colossians 2:15)**.

> “Submit yourselves, then, to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you” **(James 4:7)**.

> “But the Lord is faithful, and He will strengthen you and guard you from the evil one” **(2 Thessalonians 3:3)**.

> “No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us” **(Romans 8:37)**.

Common self-statements

- The devil is stronger than I am.
- I can’t fight this.
- Evil has a hold on me I can’t break.
- God isn’t protecting me.
- I’m just a victim of spiritual forces.
- There’s nothing I can do.

Common logical errors

- **Magnification:** Making the enemy look bigger than Christ.
- **Helplessness:** Believing you have no choices or power when God has given you both.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel powerless, so I am powerless.”
- **Mental filter:** Focusing on the devil’s schemes while ignoring Christ’s victory.
- **Fortune telling:** Predicting you will always be defeated.

Challenging questions

- Who is greater: the One in me or the one in the world?
- What happened to the powers and authorities at the cross?
- What does James 4:7 say will happen when I resist the devil?
- Is it possible I have given the devil more credit than Scripture does?
- What choices do I still have, even in this struggle?
- Has God ever helped me resist something before?
- Who promises to guard me from the evil one?

Truth summary

> Satan does not have the final power over me. Jesus defeated him at the cross, and the One who lives in me is greater. I am not helpless: I can submit to God and resist the devil, and he will flee. The Lord is faithful to strengthen me and guard me. In Christ I am more than a conqueror.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Devil
- Evil, Resisting
- Protection
- Strength
- Christ, Sacrifice of

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Satan has power over me, and I am helpless"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Satan has power over me, and I am helpless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who is greater: the One in me or the one in the world?
- ☐ What happened to evil powers at the cross?
- ☐ What does James 4:7 promise when I resist?
- ☐ Have I given the devil more credit than Scripture does?
- ☐ What choices do I still have?
- ☐ Who promises to guard me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Greater is He who is in me than he who is in the world.
- ☐ Jesus defeated Satan at the cross.
- ☐ When I resist the devil, he will flee.
- ☐ The Lord is faithful to guard me from the evil one.
- ☐ In Christ I am more than a conqueror.
- ☐ I am not helpless; I have choices and God's strength.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 John 4:4**
  "You, little children, are from God and have overcome them, because greater is He who is in you than he who is in the world."
- [ ] **Colossians 2:15**
  "And having disarmed the powers and authorities, He made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross."
- [ ] **James 4:7**
  "Submit yourselves, then, to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you."
- [ ] **2 Thessalonians 3:3**
  "But the Lord is faithful, and He will strengthen you and guard you from the evil one."
- [ ] **Romans 8:37**
  "No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Victory log:** Each day, write one way I resisted a lie or temptation, however small, and thank God for His strength.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 2 Thessalonians 3:3 becomes: "But the Lord is faithful, and He will strengthen **Sarah** and guard **her** from the evil one."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Evil, Resisting" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **When the fear or temptation comes,** say aloud, "Greater is He who is in me," then take one small step of obedience.
- ☐ **Remove one thing from your home or phone** that feeds fear or temptation.
- ☐ **Read Ephesians 6:10–18** and write how each piece of armor applies to your struggle.
- ☐ **Ask a pastor or trusted believer to pray with you,** and notice how it feels to not fight alone.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Satan has power over me, and I am helpless": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One time I resisted
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Satan has power over me, and I am helpless.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, thank You that You triumphed over every evil power at the cross. Help me reject the lie that Satan has power over me and that I am helpless. I submit myself to You. Strengthen me, guard me from the evil one, and help me stand firm. You are greater than anything I face. In Your name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.